A PRINT-AND-FOLLOW FIELD GUIDE

Turn your estate idea into a site plan.

A simple sequence for planning a large Oregon property with roads, horse facilities, pens, shops, fences, trees, and terrain references - using free tools and the planner you already have.

Your goal: a clear, editable concept for an approximately 1,000-acre estate. Start with the land boundary if you have it; if not, sketch freely and replace the planning outline later.

THE FIVE MOVES

1 Gather your land information

Find the county, approximate location, acreage, access points, and any parcel boundary file. Don't use a listing photo as a measured boundary.

2 Choose the big zones

Decide where arrival, homes/buildings, horse areas, pastures, stores, roads, water, trees, and quiet/open land should go.

3 Draw the layout in the planner

Place roads first, then large zones, fences and pens, buildings, and finally landscape details. Work in layers and save versions.

4 Check the real-world constraints

Confirm parcel lines, access, water, septic, fire/emergency access, land-use rules, and environmental constraints with authoritative sources and qualified people.

5 Improve one area at a time

Tell Copilot which area to refine, what look you want, and what must stay put. Export a project backup before a major revision.

Keep it clear: the planner is a concept tool. A 1,000-acre rectangle is not your surveyed parcel; map imagery and tree/building data may be incomplete. Do not use the layout for construction, permitting, or legal boundaries.

BEFORE DRAWING

Collect what you know. Don't get stuck on what you don't.

Land basics

- [ ] County and nearest town
- [ ] Approximate address or map pin
- [ ] Target acreage: about 1,000 acres
- [ ] Known road frontage and entrances
- [ ] Existing buildings, wells, ponds, fences

Useful files (if available)

- [ ] County parcel GIS boundary
- [ ] Surveyor-provided boundary
- [ ] KML or GeoJSON parcel polygon
- [ ] Elevation/contour or aerial reference
- [ ] Photos and notes with locations

Free source first: search the county assessor or GIS website for parcel maps or GIS downloads. A public parcel viewer may show a useful reference but not offer a downloadable boundary. For high confidence, ask the county or a licensed surveyor for the correct boundary file.

If you have the boundary file

A Keep the original file unchanged. Make a copy for planning. The planner accepts a single-boundary WGS84 KML or GeoJSON Polygon/MultiPolygon.

B In **Site Designer**, click **Import parcel boundary** in the toolbar and select the parcel file. This is separate from **Import project JSON**, which is only for project backups.

C Check that the boundary is in the right state, shape, and approximate location. Imported geometry supplies acreage; it does not verify ownership, easements, setbacks, or legal status.

No boundary file yet? Keep going.

Use the 1,000-acre conceptual extent to organize your ideas. Save your work. Later, import the authoritative boundary and reposition the concept against the real parcel.

Optional free map tools

QGIS is free desktop GIS software for viewing parcel files, terrain, and map layers. It has a learning curve; you do not need it just to sketch in the planner. Use official county/state data where possible. Zillow and Google Maps links are references only here; the planner does not scrape them for parcel lines.

County / nearest town

Map pin / address

SKETCH BEFORE PLACING OBJECTS

Plan the big zones first.

Use this as a conversation checklist, not a prescribed acreage allocation. Let the actual parcel shape, terrain, access, water, and rules guide where each zone belongs.

Arrival and access

Mark public-road entrances, a primary internal road, service routes, guest arrival, and places vehicles can turn around. Separate public/event circulation from horses, deliveries, and private living areas where practical.

Horse and farm core

Group the main barn, tack/feed store, workshop, hay and manure areas, water points, loading, and daily-use paddocks. Keep day-to-day routes short and understandable.

Pens, pastures, and fences

Sketch pasture blocks and gates, then add circular round pens and turnout pens. Choose fence concepts by intended use: post-and-rail, board, woven wire, electric tape, or no-climb. A drawing does not establish that a fence is suitable or safe for a particular horse.

Shops and public areas

Place a farm/general store, tack or feed shop, event/visitor destinations, parking, restrooms, and deliveries. Check county approvals and traffic requirements before assuming public uses are allowed.

Water, environment, and open land

Mark known wells, ponds, drainages, steep ground, wetlands, wooded areas, wildfire concerns, and land you want left open. Treat online layers as clues to verify, not complete inventories.

Suggested drawing order

1 Roads & entrances **2 Large land zones** **3 Pens & fences** **4 Buildings & shops** **5 Trees & brush** **6 Utilities & notes**

Your first-pass decisions

Main entrance should be near...

Keep visitor traffic away from...

Horse/farm core should be near...

Land to preserve as open / wooded...

Must-have buildings and shops...

Water / access questions to verify...

These are planning prompts, not engineering or zoning advice.

Don't force a 1,000-acre program onto the map yet. In the planner, acres describe a conceptual extent. The

A CALM, REPEATABLE WORKFLOW

Make a useful first draft.

1 Open Site Designer

Start in the flat plan. Check acreage and aspect under Project Settings. If the imported boundary sets acreage, use that value rather than forcing the project to 1,000.

2 Set a comfortable view

Use Fit, grid spacing, zoom, and pan. One map unit equals one foot in the conceptual flat plan. A large acreage requires zooming out to place big zones and zooming in for smaller features.

3 Search the object library

Search terms to try: road, round pen, paddock, fence, feed, store, tree, bush, grove, barn, water. Select a library object, click to place, then select it to edit dimensions, rotation, name, and shape.

4 Place and refine in passes

Pass 1: roads and entrances. Pass 2: pastures and pens. Pass 3: shops and buildings. Pass 4: fence runs and gates. Pass 5: trees, bushes, and details. Turn layers off when the plan gets visually busy.

5 Use scenarios and backups

Duplicate/compare scenarios for alternatives, such as separate farm access or a different shop location. Export the project JSON after a good work session and before trying a major layout change.

6 Use terrain and mapped references carefully

State terrain provides context and drawn overlays. The optional OpenStreetMap layer may show mapped buildings, roads, wooded areas, or individual trees; coverage varies. It sends the visible map bounds to the public Overpass service when enabled.

Make the style yours

Ask for a readable, professional planning-map style: earthy Oregon colors, terrain/elevation as context, clean labels, distinct symbols, and uncluttered layers. If you want a game-map feel, describe the mood as painterly/isometric - keep scale, labels, and measurement controls clear.

Measurements: flat-plan footprints are based on entered dimensions; terrain map measurements are click-derived horizontal estimates. Neither is a boundary survey, slope-adjusted construction quantity, or permit drawing. Confirm dimensions, grades, and locations with qualified professionals.

Backup filename / date

Scenario to keep refining

COPY THIS WHEN ASKING FOR A CHANGE

Tell the AI what to build - and what to protect.

Improve my Oregon estate planner. Keep all existing project data and current features unless I specifically ask you to change them. I want a 1,000-acre conceptual estate plan with:

Land / county / location: [fill in what you know]
Main entrance and road needs: [describe]
Horse facilities and circular pens: [describe]
Shops / stores / other buildings: [describe]
Fence types and where they go: [describe]
Trees, bushes, wooded/open areas: [describe]

Style: professional, easy to read, earthy Oregon terrain-map look with elevation context, clear labels, useful measurements, and a restrained painterly/isometric feel. Keep the plan easy to navigate.

Please make the smallest complete change, preserve saved data, and tell me what changed and how I can use it. Treat unverified property lines, map features, dimensions, costs, and regulations as planning references, not facts. Do not claim the design is surveyed, engineered, safe, approved, or permit-ready.

Before trusting a real-site decision

- [ ] Boundary, acreage, easements, and access checked with authoritative records
- [ ] County land-use / zoning and allowed uses confirmed for this parcel
- [ ] Water rights, well, drainage, septic, and utilities reviewed with relevant authorities
- [ ] Fire access, wildfire exposure, emergency response, and road standards reviewed
- [ ] Wetlands, habitat, grading, and environmental constraints checked where applicable
- [ ] Horse-safe fencing, animal flow, and facility design reviewed by experienced professionals
- [ ] Surveyor / engineer / architect / contractor engaged before design or construction decisions

Free route: keep this planner as your custom concept board; use county/state public GIS data where available; use QGIS if you want to inspect spatial files; save your own JSON backups. No paid AI or map API is needed for the basic workflow, though online basemaps require internet and their coverage varies.

Notes / next question